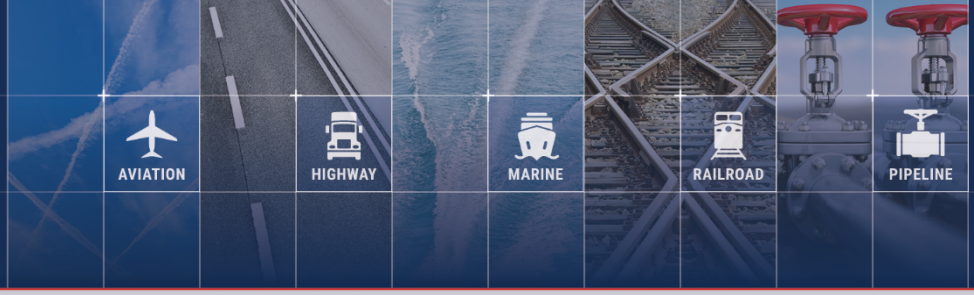

Aviation Investigation Final Report

Location:	Palmer, Alaska	**Accident Number:**	ANC25LA012
Date & Time:	December 24, 2024, 16:00 Local	**Registration:**	N3802Z
Aircraft:	Piper PA-18-150	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:	Collision during takeoff/land	**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The pilot reported that he was landing in an open field with a raised driveway that crossed the landing surface. The driveway was about two feet higher than the landing surface. The airplane was landing into a left quartering headwind that was about 15 to 20 mph. The pilot said he was planning to touchdown just after the driveway, but just prior to reaching the driveway the airplane lost the headwind and descended. The airplane touched down prior to the driveway and it bounced when it crossed over the raised driveway. The pilot attempted to go around, but did not have sufficient airspeed. The pilot then continued the landing and the airplane's right lift strut impacted a parked car, and a trailer, resulting in substantial damage to the right wing lift struts. The pilot reported that there were no preaccident mechanical failures or malfunctions with the airplane that would have precluded normal operation.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be:

The pilot's improper airspeed management which resulted in a bounced landing and insufficient airspeed to perform a go around procedure.

Findings

Personnel issues	Decision making/judgment - Pilot
Personnel issues	Aircraft control - Pilot
Aircraft	Landing distance - Capability exceeded
Personnel issues	Situational awareness - Pilot
Aircraft	Airspeed - Not attained/maintained

Factual Information

History of Flight

Landing-landing roll	Collision during takeoff/land (Defining event)
Landing-flare/touchdown	Landing area undershoot

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Private	**Age:**	60,Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine land	**Seat Occupied:**	Front
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	3-point
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	BasicMed Without waivers/limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	March 1, 2022
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	July 11, 2022
Flight Time:	(Estimated) 1500 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 20 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 0 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 1 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Piper	**Registration:**	N3802Z
Model/Series:	PA-18-150	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:	1960	**Amateur Built:**	
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	18-7535
Landing Gear Type:	Tailwheel; Ski	**Seats:**	2
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	December 16, 2024 Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:		**Engine Manufacturer:**	LYCOMING
ELT:	Installed, activated, did not aid in locating accident	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-320 SERIES
Registered Owner:	On file	**Rated Power:**	180 Horsepower
Operator:	On file	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual (VMC)	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	PAAQ,233 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	3 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	15:53 Local	**Direction from Accident Site:**	111°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	9 knots / None	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	360°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	28.84 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	-1°C / -7°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Wasilla, AK (PAWS)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Palmer, AK	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:		**Type of Airspace:**	Class G

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:		**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	61.614951,-149.07413

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Ward, Mark
Additional Participating Persons:	Christopher Pysz; FAA; Anchorage, AK
Original Publish Date:	June 13, 2025
Last Revision Date:	
Investigation Class:	Class 4
Note:	The NTSB did not travel to the scene of this accident.
Investigation Docket:	https://data.ntsb.gov/Docket?ProjectID=199467

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) is an independent federal agency charged by Congress with investigating every civil aviation accident in the United States and significant events in other modes of transportation—railroad, transit, highway, marine, pipeline, and commercial space. We determine the probable causes of the accidents and events we investigate, and issue safety recommendations aimed at preventing future occurrences. In addition, we conduct transportation safety research studies and offer information and other assistance to family members and survivors for each accident or event we investigate. We also serve as the appellate authority for enforcement actions involving aviation and mariner certificates issued by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) and US Coast Guard, and we adjudicate appeals of civil penalty actions taken by the FAA.

The NTSB does not assign fault or blame for an accident or incident; rather, as specified by NTSB regulation, "accident/incident investigations are fact-finding proceedings with no formal issues and no adverse parties … and are not conducted for the purpose of determining the rights or liabilities of any person" (Title 49 *Code of Federal Regulations* section 831.4). Assignment of fault or legal liability is not relevant to the NTSB's statutory mission to improve transportation safety by investigating accidents and incidents and issuing safety recommendations. In addition, statutory language prohibits the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report (Title 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b)). A factual report that may be admissible under 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b) is available here.